

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

of, I determined--rain or shine--train or no train, to go over to St. Mary's where Fr. Edward was assistant, and say Holy Mass and leave the rest to God. I had figured on catching the "Milwaukee" scheduled to arrive from Seattle just an hour behind us, on the "N. P." but, we had lost thirty of those sixty minutes between Minneapolis and the burned depot.

The house-keeper at St. Mary's wondered that I was back so soon from the Solemnity. The Rt. Rev. Pastor was out on a sick-call, and I got to the Sacristy just in time for the last "Dominus Vobiscum", and final blessing of the 8 o'clock Mass. The young celebrant, too, was surprised at my early appearance; doubly so, on learning of my purpose to say Holy Mass and, even then, catch a train that day for Chicago. "If you were to start for the depot now, you might catch a train", he said, glancing at his watch, but, Thanks be to God, I said Holy Mass and made a short thanksgiving too. After breakfast, needless to say, no heavy one--I lost no time in catching a trolley and getting over the half-mile or so to the station.

"Is there any train for Chicago today?" I asked what seemed to be an official just waving a train backing in to stop. "Yes" he answered courteously "Here is one now". He hardly finished speaking, when, stopped was the train; on I stepped: and off went the "Burlington" at full speed; three hours late, its first stop at Point Douglas. I need not tell you what that meant to me. It took me past where I first saw the beauties of God's visible creation, down the Mississippi, where I played in the sand of its beautiful shore some four miles below; having crossed the mouth of the beautiful St. Croix and shot past Prescott where five of us had received Baptism.

I certainly was not a tenth as grateful as I ought to have been, but I hope to be more so some day. I had reckoned, at all events, that it would please the Divine Lover of our poor souls and be good for mine especially to offer that Holy Mass; and that it would be a very easy thing for the Great God and Governor of the Universe to hold any train He might wish me to take. I hardly need to say that I asked HIM. Adored be His Holy Name! Now and forever.

I do not remember that I was anxious about connections in Chicago, I probably was, more or less, seeing that we had to go so slowly in the rain, and for a time, through a fearful thunderstorm. Just before reaching LaCrosse, we passed what seemed a victim of lightning, a burning farmhouse in the storm.